



When to Refer/Consult to a Dedicated or Designated Social Worker Overview

Article Number	Knowledge Domain Ownership	Validation Status	Views	Last Modified Date	Created Date
000036719	Care Solutions	Verified	2871	11/12/2025 01:56 PM	05/19/2021 11:13 AM

Article

Title

When to Refer/Consult to a Dedicated or Designated Social Worker Overview

Summary

Outlines when Medical Case Managers (CM), Registered Dietitians (RDs), and Coaches assess customers for a possible referral or consult to a dedicated Social Worker (SW). This initiates a collaborative process between the referring partners and social workers.

Details - Internal

Always check OLAM for clients with dedicated or designated social workers.

1. Click to expand the following sections:

[Assess for Social Determinants of Health \(SDoH\), including \(but not limited to\)](#)

Financial gaps related to SSI, SSDI benefits, VA benefits, resources for housing, childcare, elder care, utility support, legal issues, affordability of care
Transportation issues or barriers to access
Resources for support group/social support
EAP/relevant psychosocial topics
Food pantry/other community resources
Assistance and community resources related to victims of abuse or assault, child abuse, elder abuse, or other safety issues
Assistance and need for community resources related to mental health and/or substance use disorder
Gaps in care related to the caregiver or family member, or other social support systems
Grief and loss
Assistance in the identification of customer's behavioral health needs
Consult with and assist team members in cases where a customer's medical and behavioral issues are impacting their ability to set and/or achieve goals based on specific customer needs

Complex gaps in care related to discharge planning

Examples:

Customers who are current inpatient with complex or catastrophic injuries or events (i.e. stroke, MVA)

Current or anticipated lengthy hospital stay

Complex transition and known or anticipated discharge needs

Assess for possible Behavioral Social Worker needs

Customer having difficulty with medication compliance due to cost of medications.
Customer missing appointments due to lack of transportation
Customer identified as needing additional social support such as financial assistance, utility assistance, or food pantries
Financial gaps related to Supplemental Security Income (SSI), Social Security Disability Insurance (SSDI) benefits such as looking for condition-related grants, food pantries to offset costs and problem solving regarding medical debt, Veteran (VA) benefits, resources for housing, childcare, elder care, utility support, legal issues, affordability of care.
Resources for support group/social support
Assistance and community resources related to victims of abuse or assault, child abuse, elder abuse, or other safety issues
Assistance and need for community resources related to mental health and/or substance use disorder
Gaps in care related to the caregiver of family member, or other social support systems

Note: Can only provide the website for applying for SSDI/SSI, Medicare/Medicaid if that is needed.

Behavioral Social Workers can NOT assist with:

- Discharge planning, Short Term Disability (STD) (defer to what is in [OLAM](#)), eligibility for Medicaid/complete Medicaid application, assistance getting Medicare, or financial assistance with copays and deductibles (can help with a different cost to offset this).
- If no Community Support Program (CSP)/Social Determinants of Health Needs are identified, consider referring to one of the Behavioral Coaching and Support programs for Behavioral Case Management via the PreVue Assessment in the Program Referral Tool (PRT).
- If customer is in crisis, then transfer to the Behavioral Crisis 24/7 Triage team: English: 12970; Spanish: 12971 (internal #'s only).

1. Complete PreVue Assessment to determine if a referral is indicated.

If	Then
Yes	Go to next step
No	Continue to manage case through closure End Process

1. Does the account have a designated or dedicated social worker in OLAM?

If	Then
Yes	Go To How to Refer/Consult to Dedicated/Designated Medical Social Workers
No	Go To Medical Case Management and Coaching Referral to Community Support Program - Care Solutions

Case Managers, Social Workers, and Behavioral Social Workers collaborate together and should be familiar with each groups process:

Process	Refer to
Case Manager and Social Worker Process for Referral/Consult for PHT and CHAM accounts	• How to Refer/Consult to Dedicated/Designated Medical Social Workers • TruCare Dedicated Medical Social Worker Consult Process • TruCare Dedicated Medical Social Worker Referral Process
Behavioral Social Worker Process for Referral/Consult	• TruCare - Behavioral Social Worker Refer/Consult Process for Dedicated and Designated Accounts
CHAM	• Note: If a customer has been recently found to have behavioral issues, follow standard processes • Customers who have been admitted or recently discharged with behavioral issues co-morbid occurring or driving admission (including but not limited to eating disorder, overdose, assault, alcohol intoxication, suicidal ideation) presence of withdrawal/DT's while inpatient will benefit from Medical CM collaboration with Behavioral SW/CM (see CHAM Complex CM Inpatient/Post Discharge Collaboration with Behavioral Inpatient Case Managers and Behavioral Licensed Clinicians)

Related Knowledge - Internal

[Medical Case Manager Integration and Collaboration Overview](#)

Applies To

Product Line

Consumer Health Engagement (CHE); Medical Management (MM)

Product
MM>UM-CM-Specialty Care Mgmt

System
TruCare

Intended Audience
CAT/Complex CM; HIL Nurse; HRM/HPHB CM; NICU CM; Oncology CM; Premium Solutions CM; Premium Solutions Coach; TPCM

Other
Premium Personal Health Team (PHT) and Custom High Acuity Model (CHAM) accounts. Users: All Medical Case Managers; Dedicated Account Social Workers; Coaches; Registered Dietitians

Information	
Article Record Type Reference	Publication Status Online
Governance Rule-Based	Validation Status Verified
Knowledge Domain Ownership Care Solutions	Created By Ryan Remo, 05/19/2021
Effective Date 06/01/2024	Last Modified By Sara White, 11/12/2025
Article Total View Count 2871	
Knowledge Team Care Solutions Medical Team	

Detail
Information Origin Renaissance Module 369358
Url Name TruCare-Dedicated-Account-Identification-for-Referral-Consult-Care-Solutions

Versioning Information

Version Number

10

Version Comments

Updated smart link title: CHAM Complex CM Inpatient/Post Discharge Collaboration with Behavioral Social Workers/CMs to CHAM Complex CM Inpatient/Post Discharge Collaboration with Behavioral Inpatient Case Managers and Behavioral Licensed Clinicians

Approval Information**Approvals Required**

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